

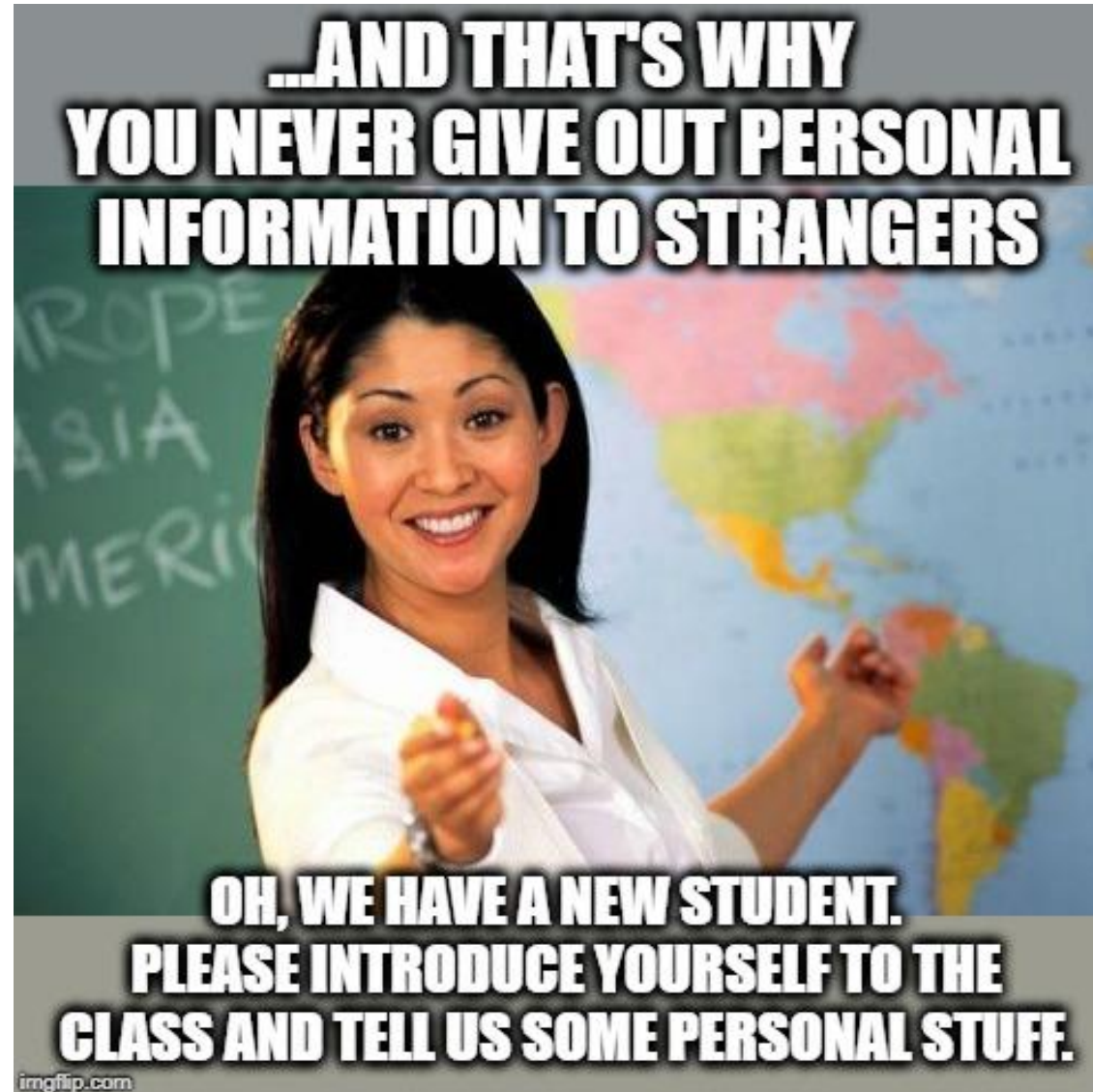
Academic Family Meeting

2026-09-17

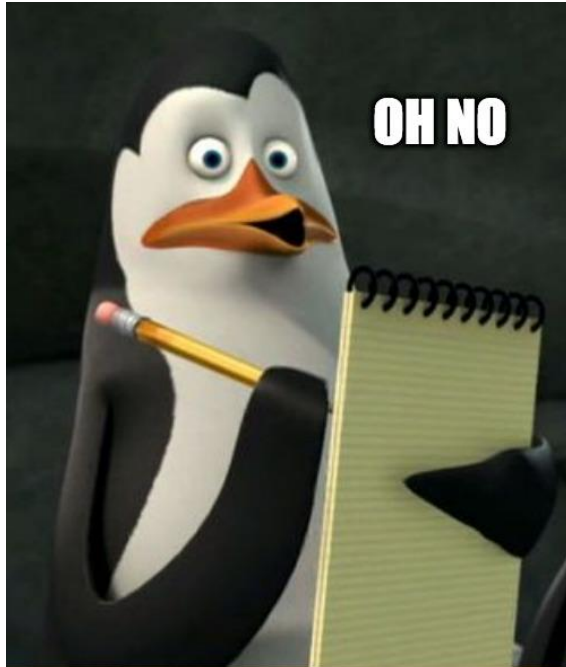
How are we all?



Introduce yourselves



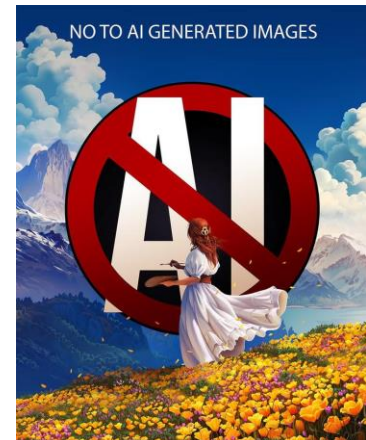
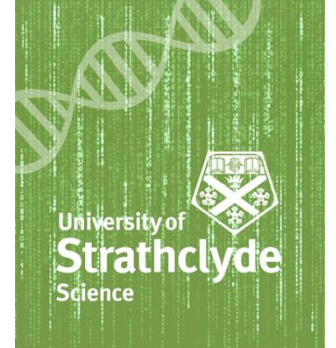
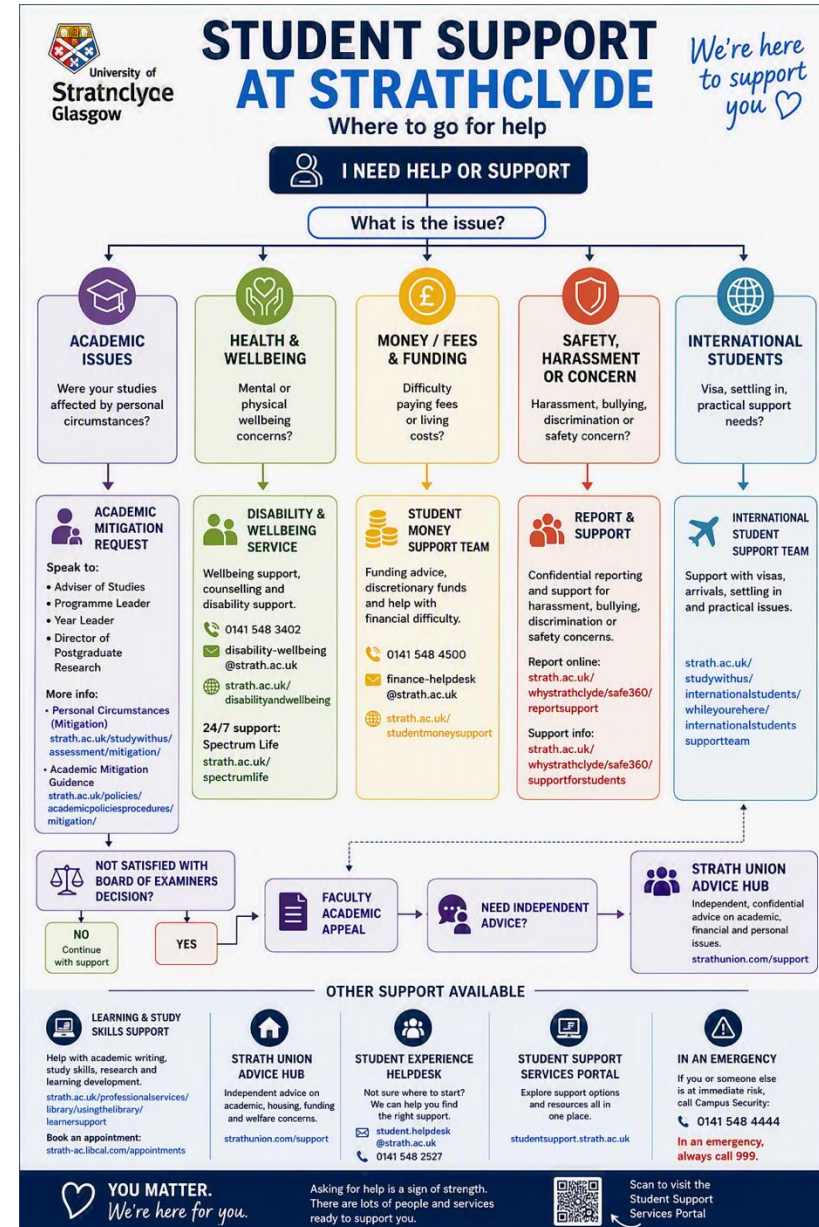
No-one has asked me to share any info



- No SPIDER/PDP component to Being a Biomolecular Scientist
 - Maintenance of SPIDER has come to an end, and everything will now come through MyPlace (BM1, BM2, BM3, BM4)
- PDA 1:1 meetings will still be available (though not to discuss PDPs)
 - S1 - w/c 19th October
 - S2 – w/c 8th February
- Next Academic Family Meeting: 14th January 2027

Ask/Tell Strathclyde

- New site for student support:
<https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/strathlife/tellstrathclyde/>
- PDA remit: personal development/wellbeing
 - Course/module info: course/module co-ordinator or academic advisor

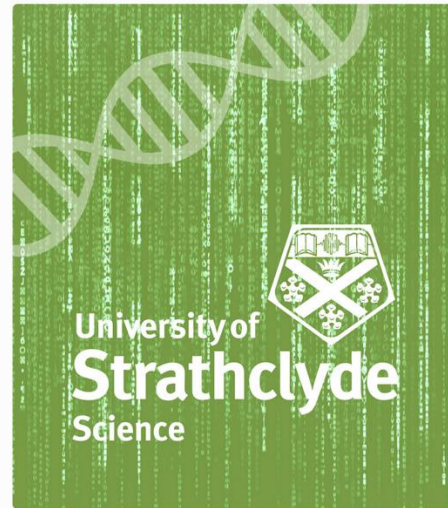
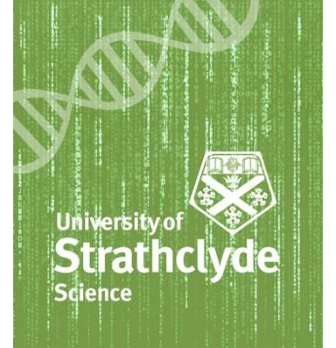


Useful Links...

- Mental Health/Wellbeing Support
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/disabilityandwellbeing/mentalhealthwellbeingsupport/>
- Disability/Wellness Support
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/disabilityandwellbeing/disabilitysupport/informationforstudents/>
- Study Skills Course
 - <https://classes.myplace.strath.ac.uk/course/view.php?id=19550>
- Strathclyde Discretionary Fund
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/studywithus/scholarships/discretionaryfund/>
- Student Support Portal
 - <https://studentsupport.strath.ac.uk/>
- Strathclyde Students Union Housing Support
 - <https://www.strathunion.com/support/housing/>

Another useful link (I hope)

 SIPBS CompBiol PDA Pages



SIPBS CompBiol PDA Pages

 Twitter  Github  Email

Welcome to the SIPBS CompBiol Group PDA pages!

What is this site for?

This site is intended to provide a persistent repository of information to support you through Strathclyde's Personal Development Programme for AY2024-25.

Warning

This site is a secondary resource!. Please consult with the official course MyPlace links for submission dates, deadlines, and other timings. Use this site in conjunction with the official information at the links below.

- [BM110: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 1](#)
- [BM214: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 2](#)
- [BM327: Being a Biomolecular Scientist 3](#)
- [BM4: Biomolecular Sciences 4th Year](#)

Information is organised under headings:

<https://sipbs-compbiol.github.io/sipbscompbiol-pda/>

Student Class Representatives

- Main Strathclyde Page
 - <https://www.strath.ac.uk/professionalservices/sees/studentpolicies/policies/studentengagement/studentrepresentation/>
- Programme/Class Reps
 - Gather views and feedback from the class
 - Present these to the department at regular Staff-Student Liaison Committee meetings
 - Report back to the class on reported issues

About Icebergs

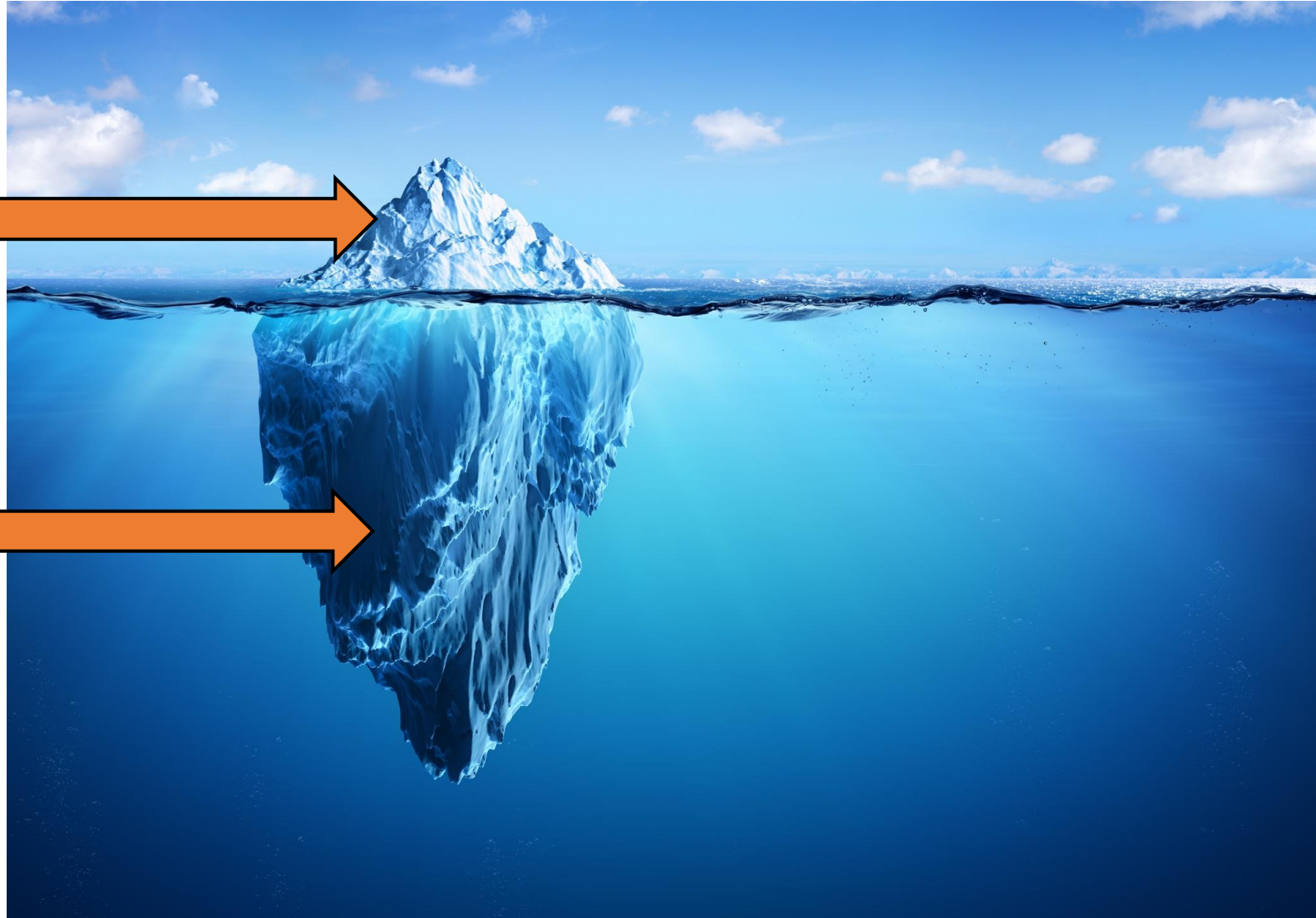


About Icebergs

The time it takes to
perform a task well



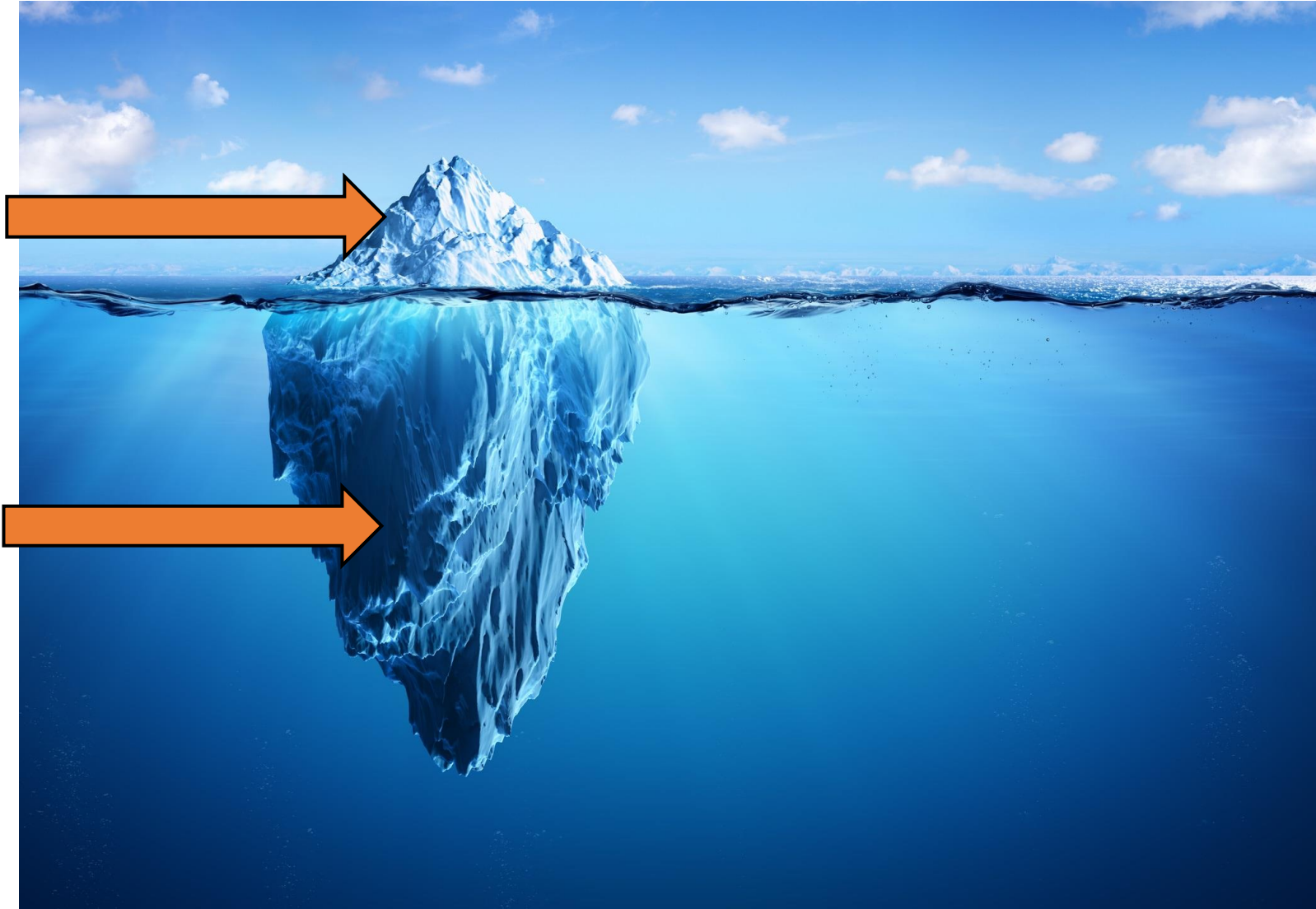
The time it takes to
learn how to perform
that task well



About Icebergs

What we teach
you 1:1
(BM329 contact
hours: 25h)

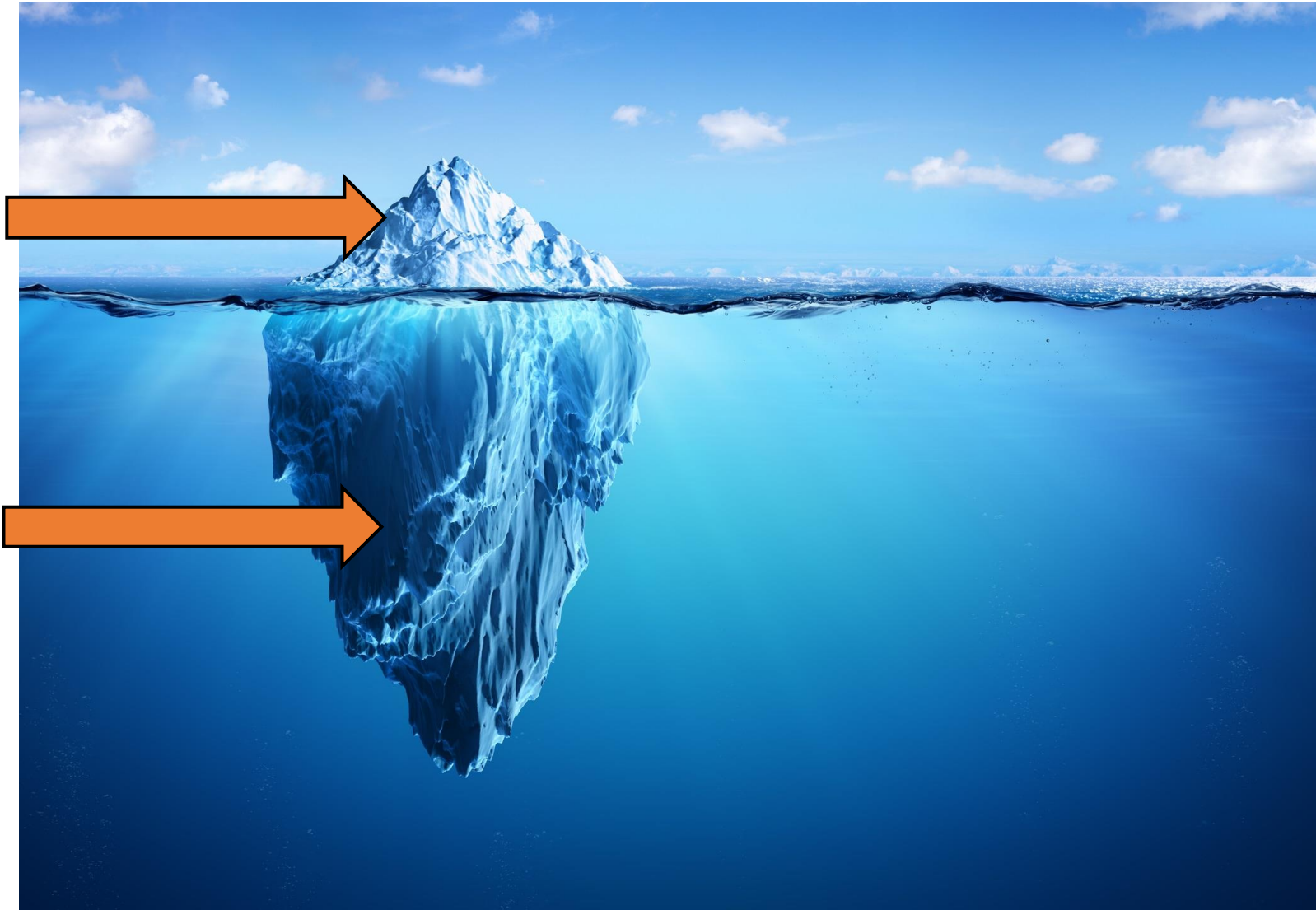
What you get from
reading/intentional
practice
(BM329 independent/
directed study: 175h)



About Icebergs

The teaching material you see in class

The amount of other material you should be aware of if you want a first

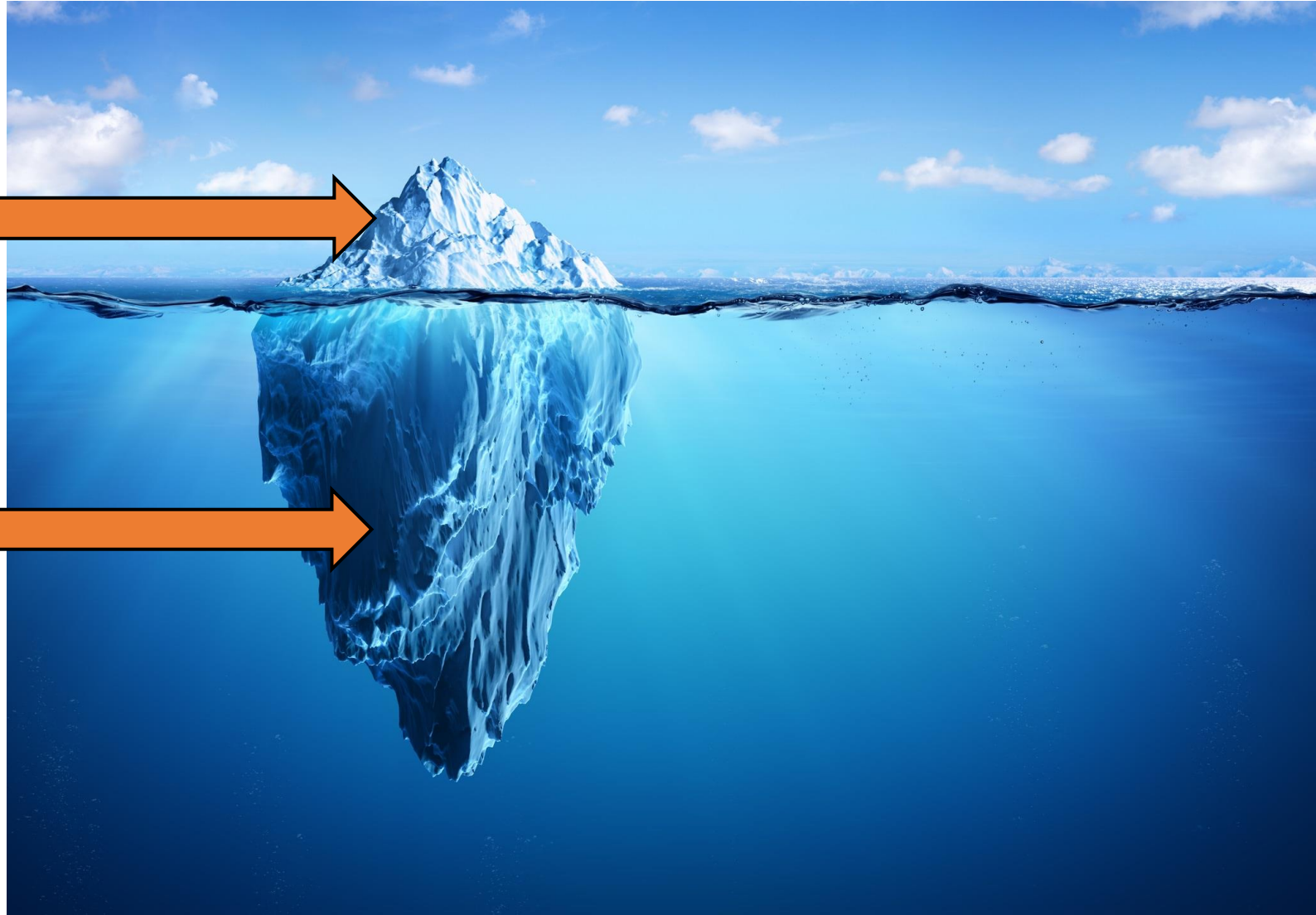


About Icebergs

What we ask
In the exam



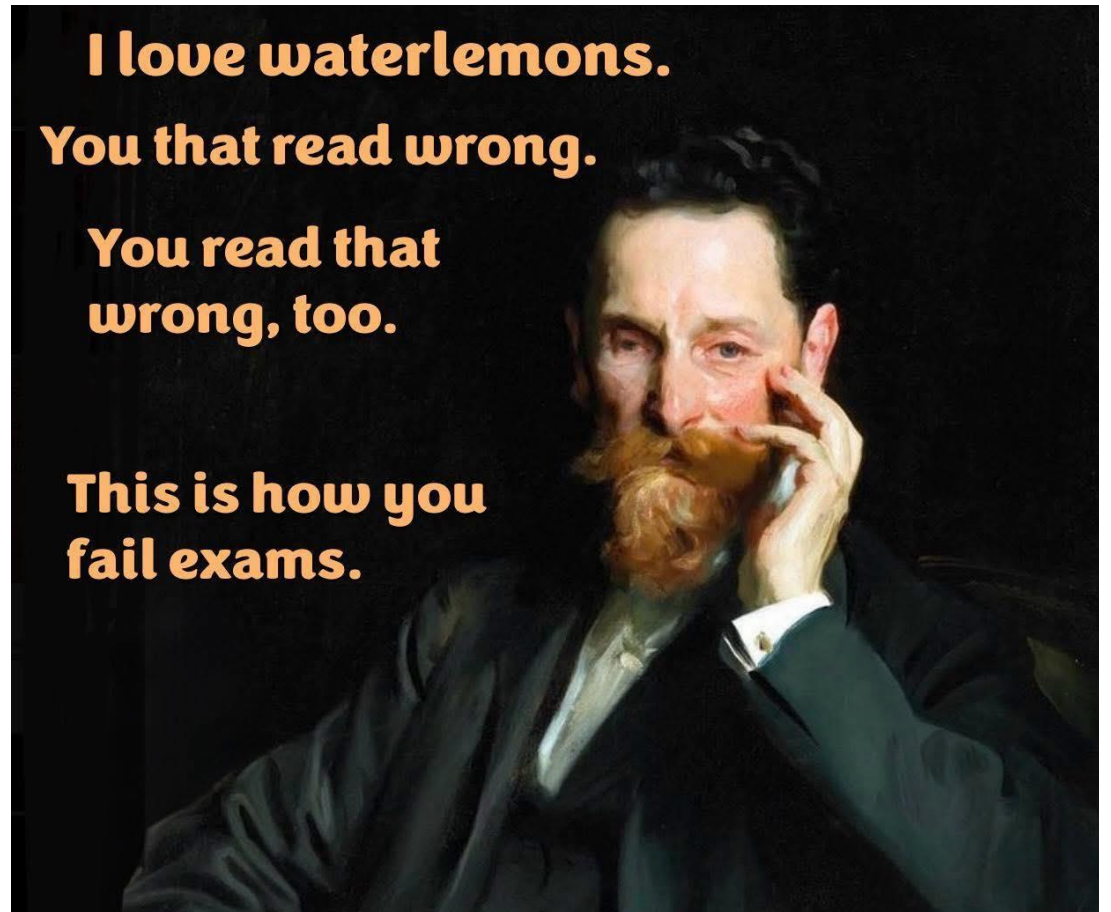
The topic being
examined



Other stuff

Doing well at exams

- Read the question
- Read it again
- Work out what the question wants
- Write that down



What motivates you?

- “Without any formal instruction, approximately 100% of humans will learn to speak, and approximately 0% of humans will learn to read.”
- “When thinking about any human ability, it’s useful to ask: is this more like speaking, or is it more like reading?”

- (<https://www.experimental-history.com/p/incentives-are-for-losers>)

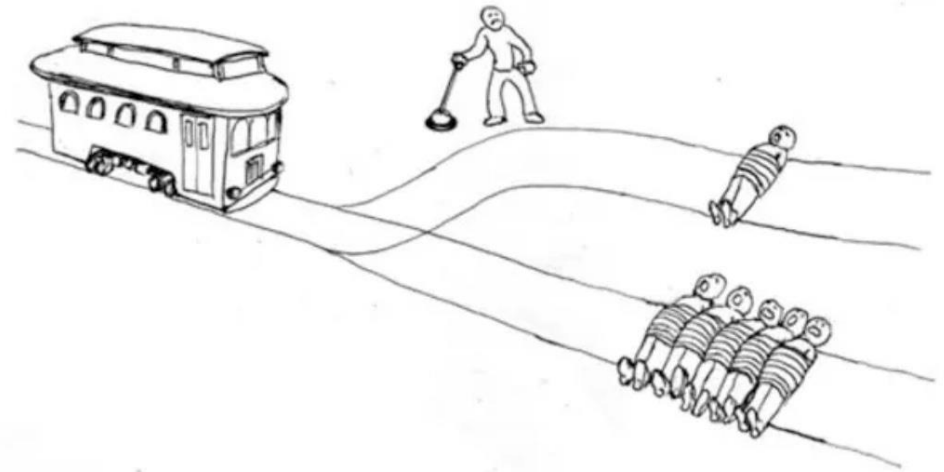
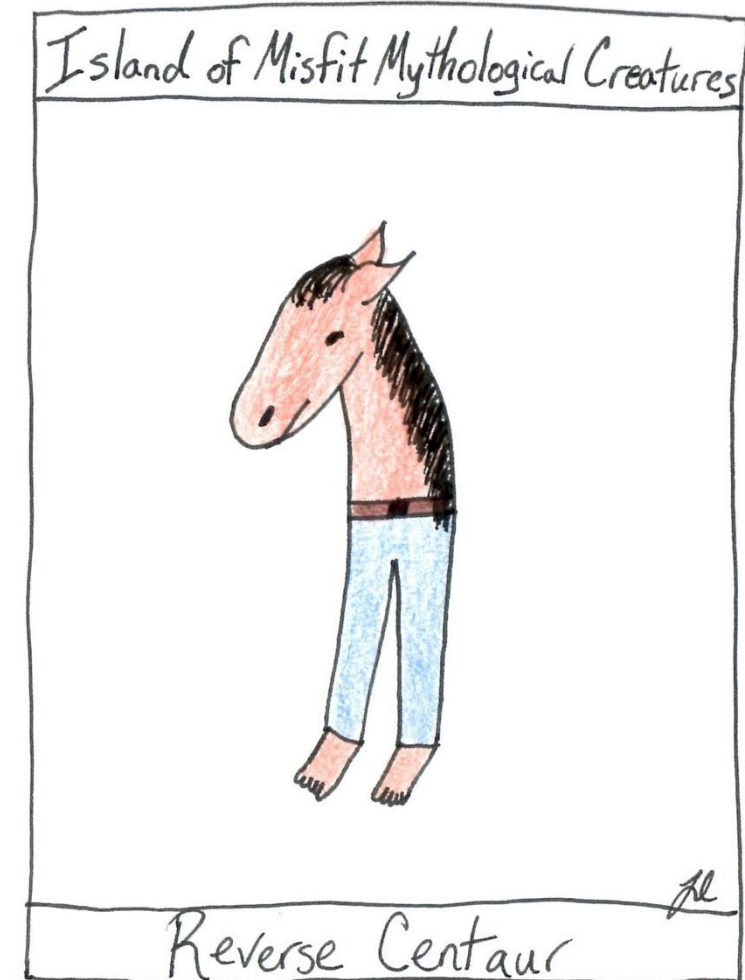


Figure: a student getting research experience so they are more competitive in the job market

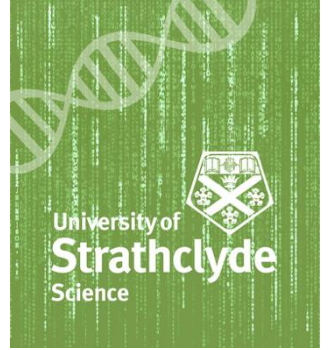
What Will You Do With AI?

- “In automation theory, a "centaur" is a person who is assisted by a machine. [...] Driving a car makes you a centaur, and so does using autocomplete.”
- “a *reverse* centaur is a machine head on a human body, a person who is serving as a squishy meat appendage for an uncaring machine. Like an Amazon delivery driver, who sits in a cabin surrounded by AI cameras [...] The driver is in that van because the van can't drive itself and can't get a parcel from the curb to your porch.”

(<https://pluralistic.net/2025/12/05/pop-that-bubble/>)



What kind of career are you aiming for?



New research from recruitment consultancy Robert Walters has shown that a change in work demands has led to a number of Irish professionals working outside of their usual hours in order to stay on top of the workload.

What was discovered is that, of those who participated in the survey, only 25pc of employees are adhering to their core hours. More than a third (37pc) stated that they either start early or finish late every day and 38pc explained that their hours are dependent on their workload.

Professionals cited a number of factors contributing to an excessively long work day, including catching up on work and meeting deadlines (54pc), with an additional quarter of people reporting that they have to work late often in order to communicate with teams working in different time zones.

Suzanne Feeney, the country manager of Robert Walters Ireland, noted that despite the **skills shortage** impacting hiring efforts throughout the region, many employers still expect the same level of productivity and output, putting immense pressure on the existing workforce.



Adam Grant ✓
@AdamMGrant

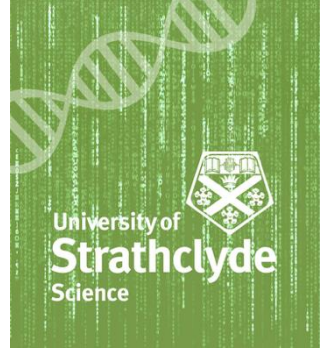
Our greatest regrets are rarely failures to reach our goals. They're usually failures to uphold our values.

Few people wish they'd been more ambitious. Many wish they'd been more courageous and generous.

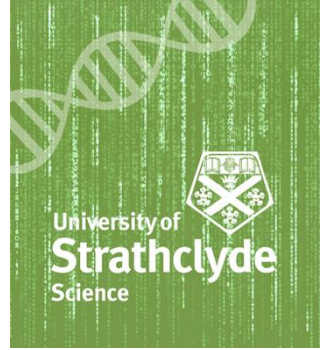
Success is in building a career.
Fulfillment is in building character.

<https://www.siliconrepublic.com/careers/employees-sticking-core-hours-research-robert-walters>

What do you want to know about the year ahead?



What advice would you give to the following-on year?



Thoughts/concerns about the year ahead?

